

ple at Jerusalem, and brought vnto Babylon) berestored, and brought agayne vnto the temple at Jerusalem to their place in the house of God.

W Get you farre from them therfore, thou Chahnai captayne beyonde the water, and Scharbuzanai, and poure councelers: Aphersechi, which are beyonde the water, get ye awaye from the. Let the worke of y^e house of this God alone, that the captayne of the Jewes and their Elders maye buylde y^e house of God in his place. I haue commaunded what shalbe done to the Elders of Iuda for the buylding of the house of God, that there shalbe diligent hede take of the kynges goodes, euen of the rentes beyonde the water, ad geue vnto the men, that they be not hyndred. And yf they haue nede of calues, rammes & lammes, for the burnt offeringe of the God of heauen, wheate, salt, wyne and oyle, after the custome of the preastes at Ierusalem, let the same be geuen them daylie with out anye delaye, that they maye offre swete sauours vnto the God of heauen, and praye for the kynges lyfe, and for his chyldre. And soch a commaundement haue I geuen that what man soeuer he be that altereth this worde, there shal a beame be taken fro his house, and set vp, and he shalbe hanged thereon, and his house shalbe made adoughyill for the same thynge.

E And the God that set his name there, destrope all kynges, & people, that put to their hande to altere to breake downe y^e house of God which is at Ierusalem. I Darius haue commaunded, that this be done with spede.

Then Chahnai the captaine of the countrey beyonde the water, and Scharboznai with theyr councelers (to whom kynge Darius had sent) did their diligence: And y^e Elders of the Jewes builded, and they prospered thorow the prophecieng of Aggeus the prophet and zachary the sonne of Iddo: and they builded, and layed vp the foundation, according to the comaundement of the God of Israel, and after the commaundement of Cyrus, and Darius & Artaxerxes kynges of Persia. And the house was fynished the thyrde dave of the moneth Adar, euen in the fyrte yere of the raygne of kynge Darius.

* (i. Dar. vii. b)

* And the children of Israel, y^e preastes, the Leuites, and the other children of the captiuite helde the dedicacion of this house of God with ioye, and offered at the dedicacion of this house of God, and hūdzred oxen, two hundred rammes, foure hundred goates: ad for the reconcilinge of all Israel twelue he goates, accorbyng to the nombze of the tribes of Israel, & set the preastes in their sondry courses, & the Leuites i their diuerse offices to minister vnto God at Ierusalem, as it is written in the boke of Moyses.

And the children of the captiuite helde Passouer vpon the fourtenth dave of y^e fyrst moneth: for the preastes and Leuites were purified, so that they were all cleane together, and kylled Passouer for all the chyldre of the captiuite, and for their brethre y^e preastes, and for them selues. And the children of Israel which were come agayne out of captiuite, and all soche as had separated them selues vnto them from the fylthynesse of the hyethen of the lande: to seke the Lorde God of Israel, did cate, and helde the feast of vñleuened bread seven dayes with ioye: for the Lorde had made them glad, and turned the hert of y^e kynge of Assur vnto them, to strengthen their handes in the worke of the house of God, euen the God of Israel.

The vii. Chapter.

By the commaundement of Artaxerxes, Esdras taketh his companions the chyldren of Israel, and returneth to Ierusalem.



After these actes, there was in y^e raygne of Artaxerxes kynge of Persia, one Esdras the sonne of Saraiab, the sonne of Asaria, the sonne of Helkia, the sonne of Sallum, the sonne of zadoc, the sonne of Ahitob, the sonne of Amaria, the sonne of Asaria, the sonne of Meraioth, the sonne of zeraia, the sonne of Izi, the sonne of Bucki, y^e sonne of Abisua, the sonne of Phinehes, the sonne of Eleazar, the sonne of Aaron y^e chefe preast. This Esdras also went vp from Babylon, and was a perfite scribe in the lawe of Moyses, which the Lord God of Israel did geue. And the kynge gaue him all that he requyred, because the hande of the Lorde was vpon him. And there went vncertayne of the chyldren of Israel, of the preastes, Leuites, syngers, porters, ad of the Aethinims vnto Ierusalem, in the seventh yere of kynge Artaxerxes. And he came to Ierusalem in the fyfth moneth, euen in the seventh yere of the kynge. For vpon the fyrst dave of the fyrst moneth, beganne he to go vp from Babylon: & on the fyrst dave of the fyfth moneth came he to Ierusalem, because the good hande of God was vpon him. For Esdras prepared his hert to seke the lawe of the Lorde, and to do it, and to teach the precept and iudgement in Israel.

And this is the coppe of the letter, y^e kynge Artaxerxes gaue vnto Esdras the preast & scribe, which was a wyrtter of the wordes and commaundementes of the Lorde and of his statutes ouer Israel. Artaxerxes a king of kynges, vnto Esdras the preast & scribe of the lawe of the God of heauen, peace and salutacion. I haue comaunded, that all they of the people of Israel, and of the preastes and Leuites in my realme (which are mynded of their awne good wyll to go vp to Ierusalem)

rusalem) go with the: and therfore art thou sent of the kynge and of his seven councelers, to vsset Iuda and Jerusalem, accordeinge to the lawe of thy God, which is in thy hande: And that thou shuldest take with the syluer and golde, which the kynge and his councelers offre of their awne good wyll vnto the God of Israel (whose habitacyon is at Jerusalem) and all the syluer and golde y^e thou canst fynde in all the countrey of Babylon, w^{it} it that the people offre of theyr awne good wyll and the preastes geue for the house of theyr God which is at Jerusalem.

E Take thou the same, and bye diligently with the same money, oxen rammes, and lammes, with their meate offerings and drinck offerings, and thou shalt offer them vpon the altare of the house of youre God which is at Jerusalem. And loke what it lyketh the and thy brethzen to do with the remnait of the money, that do after the wyll of youre God. And the vessels that are geuen the for the ministraciō in the house of thy God, those deliuer thou before God at Jerusalem.

And whatsoeuer thyng moze shall be nedfull for the house of thy God, which is necessary for the to spende, thou shalt receaue the charges out of y^e kynges treasure house. I kynge Artaxerxes haue commaunded all the treasures beyonde the water, that loke whatsoeuer Esdras the preaste and scribe in the lawe of the God of heauen, requireth of you, that ye fulfyll the same spedyly, vntyll an hundred talentes of syluer, vntyll an hundred quarters of wheate, and tyll an hundred Batthes of wyne, & tyll an hundred Batthes of oyle, & salt without measure. Whatsoeuer also belongeth to the lawe of the God of heauē, let the same be done without anye delaye for the house of the God of heauē, that he be not wroth agaynst y^e realme, & agaynst the kynge, and his chyldren.

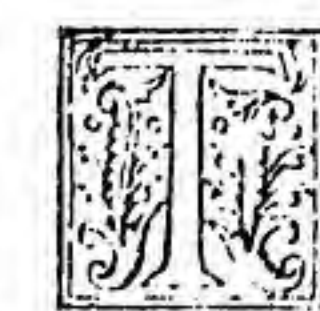
And we certifie you, that ye haue no auctorite to requyre taxinge and custome, and yearly rentes vpon any of the preastes, Leuites, syngers, porters, Aethinims ad ministers in the house of his God. And thou Esdras (after the wysdome of thy God, that is in thy hande) sett iudges and arbiters (by my auctorite) to iudge all the people that is beyonde the water, euen all soch as knowe y^e lawe of thy God: ad the that knowe it not, those se that ye teach. And whosoever wyll not fulfyll the lawe of thy God, ad the kynges lawe, let him haue his iudgement without delaye, whether it be vnto death, or to be rooted out, or to be condemned in goodes, or to be put in preson.

* Blessed be the Lorde God of oure fathers, which so hath inspired y^e kynges hert, to garnyssh the house of the Lorde, that is at Jerusalem: and hath enclyned his mercy vnto

to me in the presence of the kynge, & his councelers, and before all the kynges hye estates. And I was comforted (euen as the hande of the Lorde my God was vpon me) & so gathered I the heades of Israel together, that they myghte go vp with me.

The viij. Chapter.

The nombze of them that returned to Ierusalem with Esdras.



These are the principall fathers of Iuda, and this is their register that wente vp with me from Babilō, what tyme as kynge Artaxerxes raygned. Of the chyldren of Phinehes, Serlōm: of the chyldren of Ithamar, Daniel: of the chyldren of Dauid, Batus: of the chyldre of zecania amonge the chyldre of pharos, zachary, and with him were nōbzred an hundred and fyfte men. Of the chyldren of the captayne of Moab, Elioenai the sonne of zerahia, and with him two hundred men. Of the chyldren of zechania the sonne of Iahasiel, and with him thre hundred men. Of the chyldren of Adin, Abed the sonne of Jonathan, and with him fyfte men. Of the chyldre of Elam, Isai the sonne of Athalia, and with him seuentie men. Of the chyldre of Saphatia, zebadia the sonne of Michael, and with hym foure score men.

Of the chyldre of Joab, Obadia the sonne of Jehiel, and with hym two hundred and thre score men. Of the chyldren of Selomith the sonne of Iosephia, and with him an hundred and thre score men.

Of the chyldren of Brbai, zachary the sonne of Sebai, and with him cyght and twentie men. Of the chyldren of Agad, Iohanan, the sonne of Hakatan, and with him an hundred and ten men. Of the chyldren of Adoniam, that were the last, whose names were these: Eliphelet, Jehiel and Samaiab, and with them thre score men. Of the chyldren of Bignai, Athai, and zabud, and with the seuentie men. And I gathered them together by the water that renneth towarde Abana, and there abode we thre dayes. And I looked amonge the people and the preastes & founde there none of the chyldren of Levi. Then sent I to Eliezer, to Aziel, Semcia, Elnathan, Farib, Elnathan, Nathan, zachary and to Bessullam the rulers, and to Joarib ad Elnathan which were men of vnderstandyng, and to those gaue I commaundement vnto Iddo the cheffest at Casphia, that they shulde fetch vs ministres for y^e house of oure God, and I tolde them what they shulde saye vnto Iddo, and to his brethzen the Aethinims at Casphia.

And (thorow the good hāde of oure God vpon vs) they broughte vs a wyse man fro amonge the chyldren of Moab the sonne of Levi, the sonne of Israel, and Sarabia with

with Esdras. viii. c.

Esdras. viii. c.

Esdras. viii. c.

hys sonnes and his brethren, euen cyghene. And Hasabia, and with him Ilat of the chyl-
dren of Merari, with his brethren and they
sonnes, twentie. And of the Rechinims, who
David & the Princes gaue to mynister vnto
the Leuites, two hundred & twenty of Re-
chinims, which all were named by name.

And euen there at the water, besyde Aha-
ua, I proclaimed a fast, that we myghte hu-
ble oure selues before oure God, and seke of
him a ryghte waye for vs, and for oure chil-
dren and for all oure substance. For I was
named to requyre of the kynge, souldiers
& horsen, to helpe vs agaynst the enemy in
the waye: but we sayd vnto the kynge: The ha-
nde of oure God is vpon all the that seke hym
in goodnes, and (hys domynion) hys violence
and wrath is agaynst all them that forsake
him. So we fasted, and besought oure God
for this, and he hearde vs.

And I toke out twelue of the chiefe prea-
stes, Sarabia and Hasabia, and ten of their
brethren with them, and weyed them y syl-
uer and golde, & vessels that were appoynted
for the house of oure God, which the kynge
and his counsellors and his Lordes, and all
Israel that were there at hande, had geuen
together. And I weyed vnto their hande sixe
hundred & syftie talentes of syluer, & in syluer
vessel an hundred talentes, & in golde an hundred
talentes: twentie basens of golde of a thou-
sande peces, and two costly ornaments of
good brasse, as cleare as golde: and I sayde
vnto them: Ye are consecrate vnto the Lorde,
lyke as y vessels are holy also, and the golde
and syluer are geue of a good wyll vnto the

Lorde God of youre fathers. Watch ye, and
kepe it: for ye shall weye it downe before the
chiefe prestes and Leuites, and auncient fa-
thers of Israel at Ierusalem in the treasuries
of the house of the Lorde. Then toke y prea-
stes and Leuites that weyed syluer & golde
and vessel, to bringe it to Ierusalem, vnto y
house of oure God. And we brake vp, from
the water of Ahaua on the tweluen daye of
the fyrst moneth, to go vnto Ierusalem: and
the hande of oure God was vpon vs, & de-
liuered vs from the hande of the enemy, & ad-
of soch as layde wayte for vs by the waye.

And we came to Ierusalem, and abode there
thre dayes. But on the fourth daye was the
syluer & golde and vessel weyed in the hou-
se of oure God, by the hande of Meremoth
the sonne of Uzia the preaste, and with hym
was Eleazar the sonne of Phinehes, & with
them was Josabad the sonne of Iesua, and
Noadiah the sonne of Benoi the Leuites.
According to the nombere and weyght of eu-
ery one, was the weyght all wyrtten vp at
the same tyme.

And the children of the captiuite, which
were come out of prison, offered burnt offe-

rynges vnto the God of Israel: twelue bul-
lockes for all Israel, syxe and nyntye ram-
mes, seuen and seuentie lambes, twelue he-
goates for a synofferynge, all to the burnt-
offerynge of the Lorde. And they deliuered
the kynges commission vnto the kynges of-
ficers, & to the capitaynes that were on thys
syde the water. And they promoted the peo-
ple and the house of God.

The ix. Chapter.

Esdas complayneth on the people that had
turned them selues from God, and married with
the gentiles.



When these thynges were do-
ne, the rulers came to me, & ad-
sayde. The people of Israel,
and the prestes, and Leui-
tes are not separated from
the people of the landes (as
touchynge their abhomi-
nacions) namely of the Cananites, Hethites,
Pheresites, Jebusites, Ammonites, Moa-
bites, Egyptians, & Amozites. * For they
haue taken the daughters of the same to the
selues and to their sonnes, and the holy sede
is mixte with the nations in the lande: and y
hande of the princes & rulers hath bene prin-
cipall in this trespase.

* And when I hearde this saying, I rete-
my clothes and my rayment, and I luckte of
the heer of my heade, and of my beerd, and
sate mourning. And there resorted vnto me
all soch as feared the wordes of the Lorde
God of Israel, because of the trasgression of
the people of the captiuite. And I sate mour-
nyng vntill the euenynge sacrifice. And
aboute the euenynge sacrifice, I rose vp fro
my benynges, and rente my clothes and my
rayment, and fell vpon my knees, and spred
out my handes vnto the Lorde my God,
and sayde.

O y God, I am ashamed, and darre not
lyfte vp myne eyes vnto y my God: for oure
wyckednesses are growne ouer oure heed, & ad-
oure trespase is waxen greete vnto the hea-
uen. Sence the tyme of oure fathers haue we
bene in greete trespase vnto this daye, * & ad-
because of oure wyckednesses haue we and
oure kynges bene deliuered into the hande of
the kynges of the nacionys, into the swerde,
into captiuite, into shame, and into confusio
of face, as it is to se this daye.

And now is there a lytle & sodayne gra-
ciounes come from the Lorde oure God, in
causynge some of vs to escape, and that he
maye geue vs a nape in hys holy place, and
that oure God maye lyghte oure eyes, and
geue vs a lytle lyfe to take bryth in oure bo-
dage. For we are bondme, & oure God hath
not forsaken vs in oure bondage, and hath
enclyned mercy vnto vs in the syghte of the
kynges of Persia, to geue vs lyfe, to lett vp
the house

the house of oure God, and to redresse the de-
solacion therof, and to geue vs a wall in Ju-
da and Ierusalem.

And now, O oure God, what shall we
saye after this: for we haue forsaken thy co-
maundementes, whych thou hast commaun-
ded by thy seruantes the prophetes, sayeng:
The lande vnto which ye go to possesse, it is
an vncleane land, because of the fylthynes of
the people of the landes, whych with theyr
abhominacions haue made it full of vnclea-
nesse on euery syde. * Therefore shall ye not
geue poure daughters vnto their sonnes, & ad-
their daughters shall ye not take vnto poure
sonnes, ner seke their peace & welth for euer,
that ye maye be strong, & enioye the good in
the land, & y pe & poure chyliden maye haue
the inheritaunce of it for euermore.

And after that all these thynges are come
vp vnto vs (because of oure euell dedes & greete
trespasses) thou oure God hast thrust do-
wne oure wickednesses, & hast geue vs a de-
lyueraunce, * (as it is cometo passe this daye.)

And yf we turne backe agayne, to let go
thy commaundementes, and make contracte
with the people of these abhominacions, wilt
thou not then be wroth at vs (as not without
cause) tyl we be utterly consumed, so that no-
thyng remayne, and tyll there be no deliue-
raunce: O Lorde God of Israel, part rygh-
teous, for we remayne yet escaped, at it is to
se this daye. Behold also, in thy presence are
we in oure trespasses, & because of it maye we
not stande before the.

The x. Chapter.

The people repente, and tume, and put awaye
theyr straunge wyues.

And when * Esd. as prayed after
this maner, & knowleged, wepte,
& laye before y house of God, there
resorted vnto him out of Israel a
very greete congregacyon of men and we-
men, and chyliden: & the people wepte very
fore. And Sechania the sonne of Jehiel one
of y children of Elam, answered, and sayde
vnto Esd. as. We haue trespassed agaynst
oure God, and haue taken straunge wyues
of the people of the land. Now there is hope
yet in Israel concerning this thyng: for now
we wyll make a couenaunt with oure God,
and put awaye all the wyues (and soch as
are borne of them) accordyng to the counsell
of the Lorde, and we wyll be in the feare of the
commaundementes of oure God, that we
maye do accordyng to the lawe. Get the vp,
for thys matter belongeth vnto the. we also
wyll be wyth the, be of good conforte ther-
fore, and do it.

* Then rose Esd. as, and toke an oth of
the chiefe prestes and Leuites, and of all Is-
rael, that they shulde do accordyng to thys
worde: & they swore. And Esd. as stode vp

from before the house of God, and went into
the chamber of Iohanan the sonne of Elia-
sib. And when he came thither, he dyd eate
no bred, nor dranke water: for he mourned
because of the trasgression of the people that
had bene in captiuite.

And they caused a proclamacyon to go
thorow out Juda and Ierusalem, vnto all
the chyliden which had bene in captiuite, &
they shuld geather the selues togeather vnto
Ierusalem. And that whosoever came not
wyth in thre dayes accordyng to the deuys
of the rulers and Elders, all hys substance
shulde be forfett, and he shulde be put out fro
the congregacyon of the captiue.

Then all the men of Juda and Ben Ja-
min geathered them selues togeather vnto
Ierusalem wythin thre dayes, euen y twe-
tic daye of the nyenth moneth: and all y peo-
ple sate in the strete before the house of God,
and trembled because of thys matter, & for
the rayne. And Esd. as the preaste stode vp,
and sayde vnto them. * Ye haue trasgressed,

* Den. vii. 1.
Iudi. iii. 4.

and haue taken straunge wyues, to make y
trespace of Israel yet more: confesse now ther-
fore vnto the Lorde God of youre fathers,
and do hys pleasure, and separate poure sel-
ues from the people of the lande, & from the
straunge wyues. And all the congregacyon
answered, and sayd with a loude voyce: It
shalbe so, and we will do as thou hast sayde.
But the people are many, and it is a rayne
whether, and the people are to saynt to tarve
without in y strete, nerher is this a worcke
of one daye or two, for we haue offended ve-
ry sore in this thyng. Let oure rulers stand
therefore in all the congregacyon, and lett all
them whych haue taken straunge wyues in
oure cyties come at the tyme appoynted,
and lett the Elders of euery cytie and theyr
Judges be with them, tyll they haue turned
the wrath of oure God awaye from vs con-
cernyng this matter.

Then were appoynted Jonathan the
sonne of Asabel, and Jahalia the sonne of
Thelua ouer thys matter: And Josullani
and Sabatha the Leuites helped them.
And the chyliden of the captiuite dyd euen
so. And Esd. as the preast, and the auncient
heades thorow the house of theyr fathers,
all men of great fame, separated the selues,
and sat them downe on the fyrst daye of the
tenth moneth, to examen the matter. And vntill
the fyrst daye of the fyrst moneth they
were synnyng the busyness wyth all y men
that had taken straunge wyues.

And amonge the chyliden of the prea-
stes there were men founde that had taken
straunge wyues, namely amonge the chyl-
dren of Iesua the sonne of Josedece and of
hys brethren, Maliah, and Eliezer, Jariab
and Gedalia, and they gaue theyr handes
there

of Daseah, and Mesulam the sonne of Beso-
dia, they layde the beames therof, and set on
the dozes, lockes and barres of it. Nexte un-
to them, buylded Malatiah of Gibeon, and
Jadon of Merano, men of Gibeon, and of
Mithpa, where he that was captayne of this
syde the water had a mansion. Nexte unto
him buylded Asiel the sonne of Harhahab &
goldsmith. Nexte unto him also buylded ha-
naniah the sonne of Harakahim, and they re-
payred Jerusalem vnto the brode wall. Nexte
unto them buylded Raphaiah the sonne of
Bue, the ruler of the halfe parte of Jerusa-
lem. Nexte vnto hym buylded Jedai the son-
ne of Harumaph ouer agaynst his house: ad
nexte vnto him buylded Hatus the sonne of
Hasabnia. But Melchiah the sonne of Harim
and Hasub & sonne of the captayne of Moab
buylded the other pece, and the tower besyde
the fornaces. Nexte vnto him buylded Sal-
lum a spynners sonne, the ruler of y^e halfe par-
te of Jerusalem, he and his daughters.

The valley gate buylded Hamun, & the
cypressyns of zanoa. They buylded it, and set
on the dozes, lockes and barres therof, and a
thousande cubites on the wall, vnto y^e won-
ge porte. But the wonge porte buylded Mel-
chiah the sonne of Rechab, the ruler of the
fourth parte of Bethchar: he repayed it, ad
set on the dozes, lockes and barres therof.
But the wellgate repayed Shallu the son-
ne of Chohobah, the ruler of the fourth parte
of Mithpa. He buylded it, and layde the bea-
mes, and set on the dozes, lockes, and barres
therof, and the wall vnto the pole of Siloah
by the kynges garden, and vnto the steppes
that go downe from the cyttie of Dauid. Af-
ter him buylded Nehemiah the sonne of A-
bub, the ruler of the halfe parte of Bethzur,
vntyll the other syde ouer agaynst the sepul-
chres of Dauid, and to the pole that was re-
payred, and vnto the house of the myghtie.

After him buylded the Leuites, Rehun
the sonne of Bani: and nexte vnto him buyl-
ded Hasabia the ruler of the halfe parte of
Reilah in hys quarter. After hym buylded
they brethren. Banai the sonne of Henadad
the ruler of the halfe parte of Reilah: and af-
ter hym buylded Ezer the sonne of Iesua the
ruler of Mithpa the other pece, harde ouer a-
gaynst the goynge vp to the house of ordi-
nauce that was in the corner. Agayne, af-
ter hym brake forth Baruch the sonne of za-
chal of indignacyon, and repayed the other
pece from the turnyng corner vnto the doze
of the house of Eliasib the hye prest. After
hym also buylded Merimoth the sonne of
Aria the sonne of Hacos the other pece, from
the doze of the house of Eliasib, euen as
longe as the house of Eliasib extended. Af-
ter hym buylded the prestes, the men of the
playne. After hym buylded Beniamin and

Hasub ouer agaynst they house: and after
hym wrought Asaria the sonne of Maasia
the sonne of Anania nexte vnto hys house.
After hym also buylded Benut the sonne of
Hanadad the other pece, from the house of
Asaria vnto the turnyng of the wall, and
vnto the corner.

After hym buylded Pala & sonne of Asai
ouer agaynst the corner and the hye tower,
which lyeth out ouer from the kynges hou-
se, that was besyde the courte of the prison.
After hym Whedaia the sonne of Pharhos
(as for y^e Bethinims they dwelt in the strōg
holde vnto the watergate, towarde the east,
and to the tower that lyeth out.) After hym
buylded they of Chelua the other pece ouer
agaynst the greete tower, that lyeth out
warde, vnto the wall of the stronge holde.

But from aboue the horsegate forth, buyl-
ded the prestes, euery one ouer agaynst his
house. And after the buylded zadok the son-
ne of Immer ouer agaynst his house. After
hym buylded also Semeia the sonne of Se-
chania the keeper of the Eastgate. After him
buylded Hanania the sonne of Selemia, and
Hanun the sonne of zalaph the syxte, the
other pece. And after him buylded Mesula
the sonne of Barachia ouer agaynst his sto-
re house. After him buylded Malachia the
goldsmithes sonne, vntyll y^e house of Mithi-
nims, and of the merchautes ouer agaynst
the gate of Mephkad, and to the parlor in the
corner. And betwene the parlour of the cor-
ner vnto the Shepegate buylded the gold-
smithes and the merchautes.

The. iij. Chapter.

The buyldynge of Jerusalem is hyndred and let,
but the Jewes buylded it, bringe readye harnesse,
lest they enemies shoulde invade them.

But when Sanabalat heard
that we buylded the wall, he
was wroth in hym selfe, and
toke greete indignaciō, & mo-
cked y^e Jewes, and sayde be-
fore his brethren & the soul-
diers of Samaria: what do
these impotent Jewes? wyll the bethen suffre
them? Shall they offre? Shall they persourne
it in one daye? Shall they make y^e stones whole
agayne that are brought to dust, and brent?
And Tobiah y^e Ammonite was besyde him,
ad sayde: Though they buylde, yet yf a fore
go vp, he shall breake downe they stone
wall. Heare (O thou oure God) for we are
despised, turne their shame vpon their awne
heade, & geue the ouer into despisyng in the
lande of their captiuitie. Couer not their wic-
kednesse, & let not their synne be put out i thy
presence: for they haue prouoked y^e buylders.
And so buylded we the wall, & it was ioy-
ned whole together, vnto y^e half beygh ther
of. And the people were mynded to labour.

And

And it fortuned, y^e when Sanabalat, and
Tobiah, & the Arabians, Ammonites, & Mo-
odites heard, y^e the walles of Jerusalem were
mad vp, and y^e the gappes began to be stop-
ped, they were very wroth, & conspired all to-
gether to come, & fyght agaynst Jerusalem, ad
to make the people an hynderaunce therein.
Nevertheless, we made our prayer vnto our
God, & set watchmen by the, which buylded
daye & nyght ouer agaynst them. And Iuda
sayd: the strength of the bearers is to feble, &
there is yet moch moze moxter, & we are not
able to buyld on the wall. And our aduersa-
ries sayd: they shall not knowe nether se, tyll
we come in the middes amōge the, and slaye
the, and hinder the worke. But it fortuned
y^e when the Jewes (which dwelt besyde the)
came, they tolde vs as good as ten tymes, y^e
in all places where ye go vnto, they are ap-
pointed to fal vpo vs. Therefore let y^e peo-
ple after their kiredes wth their swordes, spea-
res & bowes bench in y^e lowe places behynd
the wal, & I lokked, & gat me vp, & sayd vnto
the chefe me, to y^e rulers, & to y^e other people,
be not ye afrayed of the, * but thincke rather
vpo the greete Lord, whych ought to be fea-
red, & fight for your brethren, your sones, y^e
daughters, your wines, & your houses. Ne-
uertheles, it chaūced that when our enemies
hearde, that we had gotten worde of it. God
brought their coucel to naught, & we turned
all agayne to y^e wal, euery one vnto his labo-
r. And fro that tyme forth it came to passe y^e the
half parte of the yong men did the labour, &
the other half parte of the helde the speares,
shyldes, bowes, and brest plates: & the rulers
stode behynde all the house of Iuda, which
buylded on the wall, and bare burthens fro
those y^e laded the. With one hande dyd euery
one worke, & wth the other helde he hys wea-
pō. And euery one y^e buylded, had his sword,
gyrd by hys thygh, ad so buylded they. And
the trompet blew besyde me.

* Ezo xiiij. c

And I sayd vnto the principal men, to the
rulers, and to the other people: the worke is
great and large, & we are separated vpon the
wall one farre from another. Loke in what
place therfore ye heare the noyse of the trom-
pet, resorte ye thither vnto vs, * & our God
shal fight for vs, & we will be labouryng in
the worke. And the halfe part of the helde y^e
speares fro y^e mozynng spyng, tyll the star-
res came forth. And at the same tyme said I
vnto the people: euery one abyde with hys
seruaunt at Jerusalem, that in the night seaso
we maye watch, and labour on the daye ty-
me. As for me and my brethren, my seruau-
tes, and the me of the watch (which were be-
hynde me) we put neuer of oure clothes, no-
moze then the other dyd they harnesse, saue
onely because of the water.

The. v. Chapter.

The people are vexed with hongre. The re-
quyeth not the buyng of a capayne.

Ad there arose a great cōplaynte of y^e
people, and of they wyues agaynst
their brethren the Jewes. For there
were some that sayd: our sonnes and daugh-
ters and we are to many, therfore wyll we
take corne for the, y^e we maye cate, and lyue.
Some also there were that sayde: let vs lett
our landes, vyneyardes and houses to pled-
ge, and take vp corne in the darth. But som
there were that sayde: let vs borowe money
for the kynges trybute & that vpon our lan-
des and vyneyardes. Behold, oure bodies as
the bodies of oure brethren, and oure chy-
dren as they chyldren: elles shulde we sub-
due our sonnes and daughters vnto bonda-
ge, and some of oure daughters are subdued
vnto bondage all ready, & no strength is there
in houre hādes, and other men haue our lan-
des and vyneyardes.

And when I heard their cōplaynte and
soch wordes, it displeased me sore, ad I ad-
uised so in my mynde, y^e I rebuked the coun-
cellers, and the rulers, and sayde vnto them:
Euery one of you is to chargeable vnto hys
brother. And I brought a greete congrega-
cyon agaynst them, and sayd vnto them: we
(after oure abilitie) haue bought our brethren
the Jewes, which were solde vnto y^e heathē.
And wyll ye sell your brethren agayne vnto
the heathen, after that they haue bene selde
vnto vs? Then helde they they peace, and
coude fynde nothyng to answer.

And Nehemiah sayde: It is not good that
ye do. Dought ye not to walke in the feare of
God, because of the rebuke of the heathen y^e
are our enemies: I and my brethren, and my
seruautes do lend them money & corne: but
as for vlturys, let vs leaue it. Therefore, this
same daye I pray you se that ye restore them
they landes agayne, they vyneyardes, oyl-
le gardes, and their houses, and remytte the
hyndred part of the money, of the corne, wyne
and oyle that ye haue wonne of them. Then
sayd they: we will restore the agayne, & wyll
requeyre nothing of the, and will do as y^e hast
spoken. And I called y^e prestes, & toke an oth
of them, y^e they shuld do so. And I shoke my
lappe, & sayde: God shalke out euery mā after
the same maner from hys house & labour, y^e
maynteyneth not this word: euen thus be he
shaken oute, and voyde. And all the congre-
gacyon sayde: Amen, and prayled the Lord.
And the people dyd so.

And fro the tyme forth y^e (the lyng) com-
mitted vnto me to be a captayne of the that
were in the land of Iuda, euen fro the. xx. ye-
re vnto the. xxxij. yere of kyng Arthaxer-
ses (that is. xij. yere) I wth my brethren lyued
not of soch sustenance as was geue to a cap-
tayne. For y^e olde captaynes y^e were before
me,